

HOUSE BILL 1896

By Maberry

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49,
Chapter 1 and Title 49, Chapter 50, relative to
nonpublic schools.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-50-807, is amended by designating the existing language as subsection (a) and adding the following as a new subdivision (4):

(4) Administer a nationally standardized achievement test that covers the subject areas of English language arts and mathematics to each student each school year.

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-50-807, is amended by adding the following as a new subsection (b):

(b) In order to operate in this state as an approved Category III nonpublic school, the state board of education shall require a private school described in subsection (a) that serves students in any of the grades nine through twelve (9-12) to administer a nationally standardized achievement test that covers the subject areas of English language arts and mathematics to each student who is eighteen (18) years of age or younger and has completed fifty percent (50%) of the high school program and to each student who is eighteen (18) years of age or younger and has completed ninety percent (90%) of the high school program, unless the student who is eighteen (18) years of age or younger completes the entire high school program within a twelve-month period in which case such student is only required to take a nationally standardized achievement test required in this subsection (b) once.

SECTION 3. For purposes of promulgating rules, this act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it. For all other purposes, this act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it, and applies to the 2026-2027 school year and each school year thereafter.